

Curriculum Vitae

Ahmet Akbiyik

CONTACT INFORMATION	 ahmetutkuakbiyik@gmail.com  linkedin.com/in/ahmet-akbiyik	 ahmetakbiyik.com  github.com/ahmetakbiyik
WORK EXPERIENCE	Quantitative UX Researcher, Meta, CA, US –Led projects within the Monetization team that informed product strategy by translating direct customer insights into system improvements. Conducted experiments to guide high-stakes investment decisions. –Built an AI-supported pipeline (unmoderated interviews + AI-assisted analysis) that takes hypotheses to product decisions in days rather than weeks.	2025-Present
	Co-founder, Galata Survey Research, Turkey –Built and led the engineering and research teams to develop a survey platform and participant pool. –Enhanced survey methodologies through innovative experimental designs and randomization strategies, improving data reliability and enabling precise audience targeting.	2023-2025
	Survey Consultant, Internews, UK Designed and conducted surveys and focus groups for media outlet audiences to enhance product strategies and audience engagement.	2021-2023
EDUCATION	Harvard University, MA, US Ph.D., Political Economy and Government Designed and executed large-scale panel experiments on intergroup dynamics and misinformation to develop policies for healthier online behavior.	2020-2025
	Boston University, MA, US M.A., Political Science (started as a PhD student, transferred to Harvard)	2020
	Bogazici University, Istanbul, Turkey B.A., Economics B.A., Political Science	2017
	Robert College, Istanbul, Turkey American High School	2012
PUBLISHED	Social Media Narratives across Platforms in Conflict: Evidence from Syria (with Erin Walk, Elizabeth Parker-Magyar, Kiran Garimella, Fotini Christia). Journal of Politics.	2025
PREPRINTS	Aiding Harmony: How International Aid Shapes Local Policy Preferences and Behavior toward Refugees (with Melani Cammett)	2024
	How Populist Incumbents Use Strategic Communication to Survive Economic Crises: The Surprising Effectiveness of Incumbent Economic Appeals (with Andrew O'Donohue)	2024
	Language-Agnostic Bias Detection in Language Models with Bias Probing (with Abdullatif Köksal, Omer Faruk Yalcin, M. Tahir Kilavuz, Anna Korhonen, Hinrich Schütze). EMNLP. Preprint.	2023

WORKING PAPERS	How Does Exposure to Discordant Media Sources Affect Political Attitudes and Behavior? Experimental Evidence from Turkey (with Jeremy Bowles, Horacio Larreguy, Shelley Lui)	
WORK IN PROGRESS	Debunking Misinformation to Foster Inclusion of Refugees: A Comprehensive Approach towards Integration and Empowerment Unpacking the Empathy-Altruism Hypothesis The effects of immersive virtual reality on attitudes and behaviors towards refugees in Jordan, Turkey, and Sweden	
SELECTED PRESENTATIONS	Debunking Misinformation to Foster Inclusion of Refugees: A Comprehensive Approach towards Integration and Empowerment	APSA 2024
	Aiding Harmony: How International Aid Shapes Local Policy Preferences and Behavior toward Refugees	APSA 2023
	How Does Exposure to Discordant Media Sources Affect Political Attitudes and Behavior?	APSA 2022
	Social Media Narratives across Platforms in Conflict: Evidence from Syria	APSA 2021
ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE	Harvard University, MA, US <i>as Teaching Assistant</i> Evaluating the Impacts of Public Policies: How to Design and Implement Randomized Controlled Trials (by Michael Hiscox) Data (by Matt Blackwell) Survey Research Methods (by Chase Harrison) Spatial Models of Social Science (by Jill Kelly) International and Global Affairs (by Matthew Bunn) <i>as Research Assistant</i> Post-war intergroup relations (by Melani Cammett) <i>as Academic Workshop Coordinator</i> Comparative Politics Speakers Series Coordinator	Spring 2024 Fall 2023 Spring 2023 Fall 2022 Fall 2022 Fall 2024 2022
	Boston University, MA, US <i>as Teaching Assistant</i> Quantitative Research Methods (by Taylor Boas) <i>as Summer Research Fellow</i> Pardee Center for the Study of the Longer-Range Future	Fall 2019 Summer 2019
GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS	The Harvard Merit/Term-time Research Fellowship, \$20,415 JPAL Governance Initiative, \$49,170 The Weatherhead Center Dissertation Writing Grant, \$20,415 The Weatherhead Research Cluster on Migration Doctoral Fellows Program, \$7,000 JPAL Governance Initiative w/ Horacio Larreguy, Jeremy Bowles, Shelley Lui, \$58,765 The Stone Program in Wealth Distribution, Inequality, and Social Policy, \$5,000 Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Research Grant, \$2,500, \$2,500 GSAS Division of Social Sciences Fund, \$2,000 Dean's Fellowship, Boston University	2025 2024 2024 2023 2023 2022 2022, 2023 2022 2018-2020
SKILLS	<i>Methodological Specialization:</i> survey and experimental methods, interviews (AI Pods) <i>Software:</i> L ^A T _E X, R, Python, SQL	